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Nick Darby's Reflection for Water Image Sample Analysis

Taking Data Science Studio for the past seven weeks has certainly kept me busy. A good busy, but busy all the same. I learned a lot, and I'm overall happy with what me and my classmate were able to produce. This was my first experience working on a project with others outside of hackathons, so the first time where the world didn't revolve around our shared project. This had a few effects on how I worked, firstly this project did not come first; it was important, good progress was made consistently, but homework, clubs, tests, and more also took time. I'd say DSS definitely caused me to become more productive and improve my time management. For example, one Thursday I had a test at 10:25am, so I planned out two hours the day before to study and another hour after it to make progress on my project. These changes weren't all fun; I had to skip playing basketball with friends, cut down on my lunch times, and spend more hours being productive than having fun. However I think the change was good, not necessarily needed. I could've spent less time and arrived at a worse end point for my project, or more time and arrived at a better one. My communication and documentation skills also improved, if I spent an hour coding, I'd spend ten minutes updating my classmate about what had changed. Our teamwork was decently fluid, not flawless, not faulty, but fluid. I definitely got better at teamwork in projects, seeing as how this was one of my first experiences. Presenting I also made progress in, not perfect but decently good. I need to spend more time practicing a specific presentation beforehand if I want it to be truly professional; however I also realized a calm demeanor puts everyone at ease.

Being in DSS definitely increased my understanding of how data science worked in and related to other fields; when we started this project I was kind of unsure as to how we would help, but now with work done it makes sense. Reverse engineering scripts, finding ways to filter data, making dashboard, all doable, all helped our project and all relate to data science. My work in DSS was also just good practice, in problem solving,

inventing, and in using github and coding in general. The course structure was decent, it was a pretty heavy workload for a ½ credit but because it was a real world project I thought it was reasonable. Overall DSS was a good class, the fact that it had real world projects made it feel like my work mattered, as opposed to other classes where after the class ends, my work won't be used again.